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考研英语强化班讲义

——阅读理解

点对点教育

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一、阅读理解

1. 社会生活及文化类

15-1-1 君主制在当下社会中的作用及影响 The Guardian 2014

King Juan Carlos of Spain once insisted kings don't abdicate, they die in their sleep. But embarrassing scandals and the popularity of the republican left in the recent Euro-elections have forced him to eat his words and stand down. So, does the Spanish crisis suggest that monarchy is seeing its last days? Does that mean the writing is on the wall for all European royals, with their magnificent uniforms and majestic lifestyles?

The Spanish case provides arguments both for and against monarchy when public opinion is particularly polarized, as it was following the end of the Franco regime, monarchs can rise above "mere" politics and "embody" a spirit of national unity.

It is this apparent transcendence of politics that explains monarchs' continuing popularity as heads of states. And so, the Middle East excepted, Europe is the most monarch-infested region in the world, with 10 kingdoms (not counting Vatican city and Andorra). But unlike their absolutist counterparts in the Gulf and Asia, most royal families have survived because they allow voters to avoid the difficult search for a non-controversial but respected public figure.

Even so, kings and queens undoubtedly have a downside. Symbolic of national unity as they claim to be, their very history-and sometimes the way they behave today-embodies outdated and indefensible privileges and inequalities. At a time when Thomas Piketty and other ecumenists are warning of rising inequality and the increasing power of inherited wealth, it is bizarre that wealthy aristocratic families should still be the symbolic heart of modern democratic states.

The most successful monarchies strive to abandon or hide their old aristocratic ways. Princes and princesses have day-jobs and ride bicycles, not horses (or helicopters). Even so, these are wealthy families who party with the international 1%, and media intrusiveness makes it increasingly difficult to maintain the right image.

While Europe's monarchies will no doubt be smart enough to strive for some time to come, it is the British royals who have most to fear from the Spanish example.

It is only the Queen who has preserved the monarchy reputation with her rather ordinary (if well-healed) granny style. The danger will come with Charles, who has both an expensive taste of lifestyle and a pretty hierarchical view of the world. He has failed to understand that monarchies have largely survived because they provide a service-as non-controversial and non-political heads of state. Charles ought to know that as English history shows, it is kings, not of republicans, who are the monarchy's worst enemies.

21. according to the first two paragraphs, king Juan Carl of Spain_____.

- [A] used to enjoy high public support
- [B] was unpopular among European royals
- [C] eased his relationship with his rivals

- [D] ended his reign in embarrassment
22. monarchs are kept as head of state in Europe mostly_____.
- [A] owing to their undoubted and respectable status
- [B] to achieve balance between tradition and reality
- [C] to give voters more public figures to look up to
- [D] due to their everlasting political embodiment
23. Which of the following is shown to be odd, according to Paragraph 4?
- [A] Aristocrats' excessive reliance on inherited wealth
- [B] The role of the nobility in modern democracies
- [C] The simple lifestyle of the aristocratic families
- [D] The nobility's adherence to their privileges
24. The British royals "have most to fear" because Charles_____.
- [A] takes a tough line on political issues
- [B] fails to change his lifestyle as advised
- [C] takes republicans as his potential allies
- [D] fails to adapt himself to his future role
25. Which of the following is the best title of the text?
- [A] Carlos, Glory and Disgrace Combined
- [B] Charles, Anxious to Succeed to the Throne
- [C] Carlos, a Lesson for All European Monarchs
- [D] Charles, Slow to React to the Coming Threats

15-1-4 诚信缺失及社会影响 The Guardian 2014

Two years ago, Rupert Murdoch's daughter, Elisabeth, spoke of the "unsettling dearth of integrity across so many of our institutions". Integrity had collapsed, she argued, because of a collective acceptance that the only "sorting mechanism" in society should be profit and the market. But "it's us, human beings, we the people who create the society we want, not profit".

Driving her point home, she continued: "It's increasingly apparent that the absence of purpose, of a moral language within government, media or business could become one of the most dangerous goals for capitalism and freedom." This same absence of moral purpose was wounding companies such as News International, she thought, making it more likely that it would lose its way as it had with widespread illegal telephone hacking.

As the hacking trial concludes-finding guilty one ex-editor of the News of the World, Andy Coulson, for conspiring to hack phones, and finding his predecessor, Rebekah Brooks, innocent of the same charge-the wider issue of dearth of integrity still stands. Journalists are known to have hacked the phones of up to 5, 500 people. This is hacking on an industrial scale, as was acknowledged by Glenn Mulcaire, the man hired by the News of the World in 2001 to be the point person for phone hacking. Others await trial. This saga still unfolds.

In many respects, the dearth of moral purpose frames not only the fact of such widespread phone hacking but the terms on which the trial took place. One of the astonishing revelations was how little Rebekah Brooks knew of what went on in her newsroom, how little she thought to ask and the fact that she never inquired how the stories arrived. The core of her successful defence was that she knew nothing.

In today's world, it has become normal that well-paid executives should not be accountable for what happens in the organisations that they run. Perhaps we should not be so surprised. For a generation, the collective doctrine has been that the sorting mechanism of society should be profit. The words that have mattered are efficiency, flexibility, shareholder value, business-friendly, wealth generation, sales, impact and, in newspapers, circulation. Words degraded to the margin have been justice, fairness, tolerance, proportionality and accountability.

The purpose of editing the News of the World was not to promote reader understanding, to be fair in what was written or to betray any common humanity. It was to ruin lives in the quest for circulation and impact. Ms Brooks may or may not have had suspicions about how her journalists got their stories, but she asked no questions, gave no instructions-nor received traceable, recorded answers.

36. According to the first two paragraphs, Elisabeth was upset by_____.

- [A] the consequences of the current sorting mechanism
- [B] companies' financial loss due to immoral practices.
- [C] governmental ineffectiveness on moral issues.
- [D] the wide misuse of integrity among institutions.

37. It can be inferred from Paragraph 3 that_____.

- [A] Glenn Mulcaire may deny phone hacking as a crime
- [B] more journalists may be found guilty of phone hacking.
- [C] Andy Coulson should be held innocent of the charge.
- [D] phone hacking will be accepted on certain occasions.

38. The author believes the Rebekah Books's defence_____.

- [A] revealed a cunning personality
- [B] centered on trivial issues
- [C] was hardly convincing
- [D] was part of a conspiracy

39. The author holds that the current collective doctrine shows_____.

- [A] generally distorted values
- [B] unfair wealth distribution
- [C] a marginalized lifestyle
- [D] a rigid moral code

40. Which of the following is suggested in the last paragraph?

- [A] The quality of writing is of primary importance.
- [B] Common humanity is central news reporting.
- [C] Moral awareness matters in editing a newspaper.
- [D] Journalists need stricter industrial regulations.

15-2-1 为何在家比在职场压力更大 The Time 2014 年

A new study suggests that contrary to most surveys, people are actually more stressed at home than at work. Researchers measured people's cortisol, which is a stress marker, while they were at work and while they were at home and found it higher at what is supposed to be a place of refuge.

“Further contradicting conventional wisdom, we found that women as well as men have lower levels of stress at work than at home,” writes one of the researchers. Sarah Damaske. In fact women even say they feel better at work., she notes, “it is men not women, who report being happier at home than at work..” Another surprise is that the findings hold true for both those with children without, but more so for nonparents. This is why people who work outside the home have better health.

What the study doesn't measure is whether people are still doing work when they're at home, whether it is household work or work brought home from the office. For many men, the end of the workday is a time to kick back. For women who stay home, they never get to leave the office. And for women who work outside the home, they often are playing catch-up-with-household tasks. With the blurring of roles, and the fact that the home front lags well behind the workplace in making adjustments for working women, it's not surprising that women are more stressed at home.

But it's not just a gender thing. At work, people pretty much know what they're supposed to be doing: working, making money, doing the tasks they have to do in order to draw an income. The bargain is very pure. Employee puts in hours of physical or mental labor and employee draws out life-sustaining moola.

On the home front, however, people have no such clarity. Rare is the household in which the division of labor is so clinically and methodically laid out. There are a lot of tasks to be done, there are inadequate rewards for most of them. Your home colleagues-your family-have no clear rewards for their labor; they need to be talked into it, or if they're teenagers, threatened with complete removal of all electronic devices. Plus, they're your family. You cannot fire your family. You never really get to go home from home.

So it's not surprising that people are more stressed at home. Not only are the tasks apparently infinite, the co-workers are much harder to motivate.

21. According to Paragraph 1, most previous surveys found that home _____.

- [A] was an unrealistic place for relaxation
- [B] generated more stress than the workplace
- [C] was an ideal place for stress measurement
- [D] offered greater relaxation than the workplace

22. According to Damaske, who are likely to be the happiest at home?

- [A] Working mothers
- [B] Childless husbands
- [C] Childless wives
- [D] Working fathers

23. The blurring of working women's roles refers to the fact that _____.

- [A] they are both bread winners and housewives
- [B] their home is also a place for kicking back
- [C] there is often much housework left behind

[D]it is difficult for them to leave their office

24. The word “moola” (Line 4, Para 4) most probably means _____.

[A] energy

[B] skills

[C] earnings

[D] nutrition

25. The home front differs from the workplace in that _____.

[A] home is hardly a cozier working environment

[B] division of labor at home is seldom clear-cut

[C] household tasks are generally more motivating

[D] family labor is often adequately rewarded

15-2-2 第一代大学生的问题 The Insider Higher Ed 2014 年

For years, studies have found that first-generation college students—those who do not have a parent with a college degree—lag other students on a range of education achievement factors. Their grades are lower and their dropout rates are higher. But since such students are most likely to advance economically if they succeed in higher education, colleges and universities have pushed for decades to recruit more of them. This has created “a paradox” in that recruiting first-generation students, but then watching many of them fail, means that higher education has “continued to reproduce and widen, rather than close” achievement gap based on social class, according to the depressing beginning of a paper forthcoming in the journal *Psychological Science*.

But the article is actually quite optimistic, as it outlines a potential solution to this problem, suggesting that an approach (which involves a one-hour, next-to-no-cost program) can close 63 percent of the achievement gap (measured by such factors as grades) between first-generation and other students.

The authors of the paper are from different universities, and their finding are based on a study involving 147 students (who completed the project) at an unnamed private university. First generation was defined as not having a parent with a four-year college degree. Most of the first-generation students (59.1 percent) were recipients of Pell Grants, a federal grant for undergraduates with financial need, while this was true only for 8.6 percent of the students with at least one parent with a four-year degree.

Their thesis—that a relatively modest intervention could have a big impact—was based on the view that first-generation students may be most lacking not in potential but in practical knowledge about how to deal with the issues that face most college students. They cite past research by several authors to show that this is the gap that must be narrowed to close the achievement gap.

Many first-generation students “struggle to navigate the middle-class culture of higher education, learn the rules of the game, and take advantage of college resources,” they write. And this becomes more of a problem when colleges don't talk about the class advantages and disadvantages of different groups of students. Because US colleges and universities seldom acknowledge how social class can affect students' educational experience, many first-generation students lack insight about why they are struggling and do not understand how students like them can improve.

26. Recruiting more first-generation students has_____.
- [A]reduced their dropout rates
 - [B]narrowed the achievement gap
 - [C] missed its original purpose
 - [D]depressed college students
27. The authors of the research article are optimistic because_____.
- [A]the problem is solvable
 - [B]their approach is costless
 - [C]the recruiting rate has increased
 - [D]their findings appeal to students
28. The study suggests that most first-generation students_____.
- [A]study at private universities
 - [B]are from single-parent families
 - [C]are in need of financial support
 - [D]have failed their college
29. The authors of the paper believe that first-generation students_____.
- [A]are actually indifferent to the achievement gap
 - [B]can have a potential influence on other students
 - [C] may lack opportunities to apply for research projects
 - [D]are inexperienced in handling their issues at college
30. We may infer from the last paragraph that_____.
- [A] universities often reject the culture of the middle-class
 - [B] students are usually to blame for their lack of resources
 - [C]social class greatly helps enrich educational experiences
 - [D] colleges are partly responsible for the problem in question

15-2-3 办公室语言的起源 The Atlantic 2014

Even in traditional offices, “the lingua franca of corporate America has gotten much more emotional and much more right-brained than it was 20 years ago,” said Harvard Business School professor Nancy Koehn. She started spinning off examples. “If you and I parachuted back to Fortune 500 companies in 1990, we would see much less frequent use of terms like Journey, mission, passion. There were goals, there were strategies, there were objectives, but we didn't talk about energy; we didn't talk about passion.”

Koehn pointed out that this new era of corporate vocabulary is very “team”-oriented-and not by coincidence. “Let's not forget sports--in male-dominated corporate America, it's still a big deal. It's not explicitly conscious; it's the idea that I'm a coach, and you're my team, and we're in this together. There are lots and lots of CEOs in very different companies, but most think of themselves as coaches and this is their team and they want to win”.

These terms are also intended to infuse work with meaning-and, as Khurana points out, increase allegiance to the firm. “You have the importation of terminology that historically used to be associated with

non-profit organizations and religious organizations: Terms like vision, values, passion, and purpose,” said Khurana.

This new focus on personal fulfillment can help keep employees motivated amid increasingly loud debates over work-life balance. The “mommy wars” of the 1990s are still going on today, prompting arguments about why women still can't have it all and books like Sheryl Sandberg's *Lean In*, whose title has become a buzzword in its own right. Terms like unplug, offline, life-hack, bandwidth, and capacity are all about setting boundaries between the office and the home. But if your work is your “passion,” you'll be more likely to devote yourself to it, even if that means going home for dinner and then working long after the kids are in bed.

But this seems to be the irony of office speak: Everyone makes fun of it, but managers love it, companies depend on it, and regular people willingly absorb it. As Nunberg said, “You can get people to think it's nonsense at the same time that you buy into it.” In a workplace that's fundamentally in different to your life and its meaning, office speak can help you figure out how you relate to your work and how your work defines who you are.

31. According to Nancy Koehn, office language has become _____.

- [A] more emotional
- [B] more objective
- [C] less energetic
- [D] less strategic

32. “Team”-oriented corporate vocabulary is closely related to _____.

- [A] historical incidents
- [B] gender difference
- [C] sports culture
- [D] athletic executives

33. Khurana believes that the importation of terminology aims to _____.

- [A] revive historical terms
- [B] promote company image
- [C] foster corporate cooperation
- [D] strengthen employee loyalty

34. It can be inferred that *Lean In* _____.

- [A] voices for working women
- [B] appeals to passionate workaholics
- [C] triggers debates among mommies
- [D] praises motivated employees

35. Which of the following statements is true about office speak?

- [A] Managers admire it but avoid it
- [B] Linguists believe it to be nonsense
- [C] Companies find it to be fundamental
- [D] Regular people mock it but accept it

14-1-1 失业者的救济金 The Guardian 2013

In order to “change lives for the better” and reduce “dependency,” George Osborne, Chancellor of the Exchequer, introduced the “upfront work search” scheme. Only if the jobless arrive at the job center with a CV register for online job search, and start looking for work will they be eligible for benefit and then they should report weekly rather than fortnightly. What could be more reasonable?

More apparent reasonableness followed. There will now be a seven-day wait for the jobseeker’s allowance. “Those first few days should be spent looking for work, not looking to sign on.” he claimed. “We’re doing these things because we know they help people say off benefits and help those on benefits get into work faster” Help? Really? On first hearing, this was the socially concerned chancellor, trying to change lives for the better, complete with “reforms” to an obviously indulgent system that demands too little effort from the newly unemployed to find work, and subsidizes laziness. What motivated him, we were to understand, was his zeal for “fundamental fairness” protecting the taxpayer, controlling spending and ensuring that only the most deserving claimants received their benefits.

Losing a job is hurting: you don’t skip down to the job center with a song in your heart, delighted at the prospect of doubling your income from the generous state. It is financially terrifying, psychologically embarrassing and you know that support is minimal and extraordinarily hard to get. You are now not wanted; you are now excluded from the work environment that offers purpose and structure in your life. Worse, the crucial income to feed yourself and your family and pay the bills has disappeared. Ask anyone newly unemployed what they want and the answer is always: a job.

But in Osborneland, your first instinct is to fall into dependency —permanent dependency if you can get it — supported by a state only too ready to indulge your falsehood. It is as though 20 years of ever-tougher reforms of the job search and benefit administration system never happened. The principle of British welfare is no longer that you can insure yourself against the risk of unemployment and receive unconditional payments if the disaster happens. Even the very phrase “jobseeker’s allowance” — invented in 1996 — is about redefining the unemployed as a “jobseeker” who had no mandatory right to a benefit he or she has earned through making national insurance contributions. Instead, the claimant receives a time-limited “allowance,” conditional on actively seeking a job; no entitlement and no insurance, at \$71.70 a week, one of the least generous in the EU.

21. George Osborne’s scheme was intended to

- [A] provide the unemployed with easier access to benefits.
- [B] encourage jobseekers’ active engagement in job seeking.
- [C] motivate the unemployed to report voluntarily.
- [D] guarantee jobseekers’ legitimate right to benefits.

22. The phrase “to sign on”(Line 3, Para. 2) most probably means

- [A] to check on the availability of jobs at the jobcentre.
- [B] to accept the government’s restrictions on the allowance.
- [C] to register for an allowance from the government.
- [D] to attend a governmental job-training program.

23. What promoted the chancellor to develop his scheme?

- [A]A desire to secure a better life for all.
- [B]An eagerness to protect the unemployed.
- [C]An urge to be generous to the claimants.
- [D]A passion to ensure fairness for taxpayers.

24. According to Paragraph 3, being unemployed makes one feel

- [A]uneasy.
- [B]enraged.
- [C]insulted.
- [D]guilty.

25. To which of the following would the author most probably agree?

- [A]The British welfare system indulges jobseekers' laziness.
- [B]Osborne's reforms will reduce the risk of unemployment.
- [C]The jobseekers' allowance has met their actual needs.
- [D]Unemployment benefits should not be made conditional.

14-1-2 律师行业改革 The Economist 2013

All around the world, lawyers generate more hostility than the members of any other profession---with the possible exception of journalism. But there are few places where clients have more grounds for complaint than America.

During the decade before the economic crisis, spending on legal services in America grew twice as fast as inflation. The best lawyers made skyscrapers-full of money, tempting ever more students to pile into law schools. But most law graduates never get a big-firm job. Many of them instead become the kind of nuisance-lawsuit filer that makes the tort system a costly nightmare.

There are many reasons for this. One is the excessive costs of a legal education. There is just one path for a lawyer in most American states: a four-year undergraduate degree in some unrelated subject, then a three-year law degree at one of 200 law schools authorized by the American Bar Association and an expensive preparation for the bar exam. This leaves today's average law-school graduate with \$100,000 of debt on top of undergraduate debts. Law-school debt means that they have to work fearsomely hard.

Reforming the system would help both lawyers and their customers. Sensible ideas have been around for a long time, but the state-level bodies that govern the profession have been too conservative to implement them. One idea is to allow people to study law as an undergraduate degree. Another is to let students sit for the bar after only two years of law school. If the bar exam is truly a stern enough test for a would-be lawyer, those who can sit it earlier should be allowed to do so. Students who do not need the extra training could cut their debt mountain by a third. The other reason why costs are so high is the restrictive guild-like ownership structure of the business. Except in the District of Columbia, non-lawyers may not own any share of a law firm. This keeps fees high and innovation slow. There is pressure for change from within the profession, but opponents of change among the regulators insist that keeping outsiders out of a law firm isolates lawyers from the pressure to make money rather than serve clients ethically.

In fact, allowing non-lawyers to own shares in law firms would reduce costs and improve services to customers, by encouraging law firms to use technology and to employ professional managers to focus on improving firms' efficiency. After all, other countries, such as Australia and Britain, have started liberalizing their legal professions. America should follow.

26. A lot of students take up law as their profession due to

- [A]the growing demand from clients.
- [B]the increasing pressure of inflation.
- [C]the prospect of working in big firms.
- [D]the attraction of financial rewards.

27. Which of the following adds to the costs of legal education in most American states?

- [A]Higher tuition fees for undergraduate studies.
- [B]Admissions approval from the bar association.
- [C]Pursuing a bachelor's degree in another major.
- [D]Receiving training by professional associations.

28. Hindrance to the reform of the legal system originates from

- [A]lawyers' and clients' strong resistance.
- [B]the rigid bodies governing the profession.
- [C]the stem exam for would-be lawyers.
- [D]non-professionals' sharp criticism.

29. The guild-like ownership structure is considered "restrictive" partly because it

- [A]bans outsiders' involvement in the profession.
- [B]keeps lawyers from holding law-firm shares.
- [C]aggravates the ethical situation in the trade.
- [D]prevents lawyers from gaining due profits.

30. In this text, the author mainly discusses

- [A]flawed ownership of America's law firms and its causes.
- [B]the factors that help make a successful lawyer in America.
- [C]a problem in America's legal profession and solutions to it.
- [D]the role of undergraduate studies in America's legal education.

14-1-4 美国文科教育 The Wall Street Journal 2013

"The Heart of the Matter," the just-released report by the American Academy of Arts and Sciences, deserves praise for affirming the importance of the humanities and social sciences to the prosperity and security of liberal democracy in America. Regrettably, however, the report's failure to address the true nature of the crisis facing liberal education may cause more harm than good.

In 2010, leading congressional Democrats and Republicans sent letters to the American Academy of Arts and Sciences asking that it identify actions that could be taken by "federal, state and local governments, universities, foundations, educators, individual benefactors and others" to "maintain national excellence in

humanities and social scientific scholarship and education."In response, the American Academy formed the Commission on the Humanities and Social Sciences, with Duke University President Richard Brodhead and retired Exelon CEO John Rowe as co-chairmen. Among the commission's 51 members are top-tier-university presidents, scholars, lawyers, judges, and business executives, as well as prominent figures from diplomacy, filmmaking, music and journalism.

The goals identified in the report are generally admirable. Because representative government presupposes an informed citizenry, the report supports full literacy; stresses the study of history and government, particularly American history and American government; and encourages the use of new digital technologies. To encourage innovation and competition, the report calls for increased investment in research, the crafting of coherent curricula that improve students' ability to solve problems and communicate effectively in the 21st century, increased funding for teachers and the encouragement of scholars to bring their learning to bear on the great challenges of the day. The report also advocates greater study of foreign languages, international affairs and the expansion of study abroad programs. One of the more novel ideas in the report is the creation of a "Culture Corps" in cities and town across America to "transmit humanistic and social scientific expertise from one generation to the next."

Unfortunately, despite 2.5 years in the making, "The Heart of the Matter" never gets to the heart of the matter: the illiberal nature of liberal education at our leading colleges and universities. The commission ignores that for several decades America's colleges and universities have produced graduates who don't know the content and character of liberal education and are thus deprived of its benefits. Sadly, the spirit of inquiry once at home on campus has been replaced by the use of the humanities and social sciences as vehicles for disseminating "progressive," or left-liberal propaganda.

Today, professors routinely treat the progressive interpretation of history and progressive public policy as the proper subject of study while portraying conservative or classical liberal ideas—such as free markets, self-reliance and a distrust of central planning—as falling outside the boundaries of routine, and sometimes legitimate, intellectual investigation.

The AAAS displays great enthusiasm for liberal education. Yet its report may well set back reform by obscuring the depth and breadth of the challenge that congress asked it to illuminate.

36. According to Paragraph 1, what is the author's attitude toward the AAAS's report?

- [A] Critical
- [B] Appreciative
- [C] Contemptuous
- [D] Tolerant

37. Influential figures in the Congress required that the AAAS report on how to

- [A] retain people's interest in liberal education
- [B] define the government's role in education
- [C] keep a leading position in liberal education
- [D] safeguard individuals rights to education

38. According to Paragraph 3, the report suggests

- [A] an exclusive study of American history
- [B] a greater emphasis on theoretical subjects

- [C] the application of emerging technologies
[D] funding for the study of foreign languages
39. The author implies in Paragraph S that professors are
- [A] supportive of free markets
[B] cautious about intellectual investigation
[C] conservative about public policy
[D] biased against classical liberal ideas
40. Which of the following would be the best title for the text?
- [A] Ways to Grasp “The Heart of the Matter”
[B] Illiberal Education and “The Heart of the Matter”
[C] The AAAS’s Contribution to Liberal Education
[D] Progressive Policy vs. Liberal Education

13-1-4 亚利桑那州移民法案通过引争议 The Wall Street Journal 2012

On a five to three vote, the Supreme Court knocked out much of Arizona’s immigration law Monday—a modest policy victory for the Obama Administration. But on the more important matter of the Constitution, the decision was an 8-0 defeat for the Administration’s effort to upset the balance of power between the federal government and the states.

In *Arizona v. United States*, the majority overturned three of the four contested provisions of Arizona’s controversial plan to have state and local police enforce federal immigration law. The Constitutional principles that Washington alone has the power to “establish a uniform Rule of Naturalization” and that federal laws precede state laws are noncontroversial. Arizona had attempted to fashion state policies that ran parallel to the existing federal ones.

Justice Anthony Kennedy, joined by Chief Justice John Roberts and the Court’s liberals, ruled that the state flew too close to the federal sun. On the overturned provisions the majority held the congress had deliberately “occupied the field” and Arizona had thus intruded on the federal’s privileged powers.

However, the Justices said that Arizona police would be allowed to verify the legal status of people who come in contact with law enforcement. That’s because Congress has always envisioned joint federal-state immigration enforcement and explicitly encourages state officers to share information and cooperate with federal colleagues.

Two of the three objecting Justices—Samuel Alito and Clarence Thomas—agreed with this Constitutional logic but disagreed about which Arizona rules conflicted with the federal statute. The only major objection came from Justice Antonin Scalia, who offered an even more robust defense of state privileges going back to the alien and Sedition Acts.

The 8-0 objection to President Obama turns on what Justice Samuel Alito describes in his objection as “a shocking assertion of federal executive power”. The White House argued that Arizona’s laws conflicted with its enforcement priorities, even if state laws complied with federal statutes to the letter. In effect, the White House claimed that it could invalidate any otherwise legitimate state law that it disagrees with.

Some powers do belong exclusively to the federal government, and control of citizenship and the borders is among them. But if Congress wanted to prevent states from using their own resources to check immigration

status, it could. It never did so. The administration was in essence asserting that because it didn't want to carry out Congress's immigration wishes, no state should be allowed to do so either. Every Justice rightly rejected this remarkable claim.

36. Three provisions of Arizona's plan were overturned because they
- [A] overstepped the authority of federal immigration law.
 - [B] disturbed the power balance between different states.
 - [C] deprived the federal police of Constitutional powers.
 - [D] contradicted both the federal and state policies.
37. On which of the following did the Justices agree, according to Paragraph 4?
- [A] States' independence from federal immigration law.
 - [B] Federal officers' duty to withhold immigrants' information.
 - [C] States' legitimate role in immigration enforcement.
 - [D] Congress's intervention in immigration enforcement.
38. It can be inferred from Paragraph 5 that the Alien and Sedition Acts
- [A] violated the Constitution.
 - [B] stood in favor of the states.
 - [C] supported the federal statute.
 - [D] undermined the states' interests.
39. The White House claims that its power of enforcement
- [A] outweighs that held by the states.
 - [B] is established by federal statutes.
 - [C] is dependent on the states' support.
 - [D] rarely goes against state laws.
40. What can be learned from the last paragraph?
- [A] Immigration issues are usually decided by Congress.
 - [B] The Administration is dominant over immigration issues.
 - [C] Justices wanted to strengthen its coordination with Congress.
 - [D] Justices intended to check the power of the Administration.

10-1-1 报纸的文艺评论衰落 Commentary 2007

Of all the changes that have taken place in English-language newspapers during the past quarter-century, perhaps the most far-reaching has been the inexorable decline in the scope and seriousness of their arts coverage.

It is difficult to the point of impossibility for the average reader under the age of forty to imagine a time when high-quality arts criticism could be found in most big-city newspapers. Yet a considerable number of the most significant collections of criticism published in the 20th century consisted in large part of newspaper reviews. To read such books today is to marvel at the fact that their learned contents were once deemed suitable for publication in general-circulation dailies.

We are even farther removed from the unfocused newspaper reviews published in England between the turn of the 20th century and the eve of World War II, at a time when newsprint was dirt-cheap and stylish arts criticism was considered an ornament to the publications in which it appeared. In those far-off days, it was taken for granted that the critics of major papers would write in detail and at length about the events they covered. Theirs was a serious business, and even those reviewers who wore their learning lightly, like George Bernard Shaw and Ernest Newman, could be trusted to know what they were about. These men believed in journalism as a calling, and were proud to be published in the daily press. "So few authors have brains enough or literary gift enough to keep their own end up in journalism," Newman wrote, "that I am tempted to define 'journalism' as 'a term of contempt applied by writers who are not read to writers who are'."

Unfortunately, these critics are virtually forgotten. Neville Cardus, who wrote for the Manchester Guardian from 1917 until shortly before his death in 1975, is now known solely as a writer of essays on the game of cricket. During his lifetime, though, he was also one of England's foremost classical-music critics, a stylist so widely admired that his Autobiography (1947) became a best-seller. He was knighted in 1967, the first music critic to be so honored. Yet only one of his books is now in print, and his vast body of writings on music is unknown save to specialists.

Is there any chance that Cardus's criticism will enjoy a revival? The prospect seems remote. Journalistic tastes had changed long before his death, and postmodern readers have little use for the richly upholstered Vicwardian prose in which he specialized. Moreover, the amateur tradition in music criticism has been in headlong retreat.

21. It is indicated in Paragraphs 1 and 2 that
 - [A] arts criticism has disappeared from big-city newspapers.
 - [B] English-language newspapers used to carry more arts reviews.
 - [C] high-quality newspapers retain a large body of readers.
 - [D] young readers doubt the suitability of criticism on dailies.
22. Newspaper reviews in England before World War II were characterized by
 - [A] free themes.
 - [B] casual style.
 - [C] elaborate layout.
 - [D] radical viewpoints.
23. Which of the following would Shaw and Newman most probably agree on?
 - [A] It is writers' duty to fulfill journalistic goals.
 - [B] It is contemptible for writers to be journalists.
 - [C] Writers are likely to be tempted into journalism.
 - [D] Not all writers are capable of journalistic writing.
24. What can be learned about Cardus according to the last two paragraphs?
 - [A] His music criticism may not appeal to readers today.
 - [B] His reputation as a music critic has long been in dispute.
 - [C] His style caters largely to modern specialists.
 - [D] His writings fail to follow the amateur tradition.
25. What would be the best title for the text?

- [A] Newspapers of the Good Old Days
- [B] The Lost Horizon in Newspapers
- [C] Mournful Decline of Journalism
- [D] Prominent Critics in Memory

2.经济类

15-2-4 奥巴马保险新政与市场就业关系 Center for Economic and Policy

Research 2014

Many people talked of the 288, 000 new jobs the Labor Department reported for June, along with the drop in the unemployment rate to 6.1 percent, as good news. And they were right. For now it appears the economy is creating jobs at a decent pace. We still have a long way to go to get back to full employment, but at least we are now finally moving forward at a faster pace.

However, there is another important part of the jobs picture that was largely overlooked. There was a big jump in the number of people who report voluntarily working part-time. This figure is now 830, 000 (4.4 percent) above its year ago level.

Before explaining the connection to the Obamacare, it is worth making an important distinction. Many people who work part-time jobs actually want full-time jobs. They take part-time work because this is all they can get. An increase in involuntary part-time work is evidence of weakness in the labor market and it means that many people will be having a very hard time making ends meet.

There was an increase in voluntary part-time in June, but the general direction has been down. Involuntary part-time employment is still far higher than before the recession, but it is down by 640, 000 (7.9 percent) from its year ago level.

We know the difference between voluntary and involuntary part-time employment because people tell us. The survey used by the Labor Department asks people if they worked less than 35 hours in the reference week. If the answer is “yes,” they are classified as working part-time. The survey then asks whether they worked less than 35 hours in that week because they wanted to work less than full time or because they had no choice. They are only classified as voluntary part-time workers if they tell the survey taker they chose to work less than 35 hours a week.

The issue of voluntary part-time relates to Obamacare because one of the main purposes was to allow people to get insurance outside of employment. For many people, especially those with serious health conditions of family members with serious health conditions, before Obamacare the only way to get insurance was through a job that provided health insurance.

However, Obamacare has allowed more than 12 million people to either get insurance through Medicaid or the exchanges. These are people who may previously have felt the need to get a full-time job that provided insurance in order to cover themselves and their families. With Obamacare there is no longer a link between employment and insurance.

36. Which part of the jobs picture was neglected?
- A. The prospect of a thriving job market.
 - B. The increase of voluntary part-time jobs.
 - C. The possibility of full employment.
 - D. The acceleration of job creation.
37. Many people work part-time because they_____.
- A. prefer part-time jobs to full-time jobs
 - B. feel that is enough to make ends meet
 - C. cannot get their hands on full-time jobs
 - D. haven't seen the weakness of the market
38. Involuntary part-time employment in the US
- A. is harder to acquire than one year ago
 - B. shows a general tendency of decline
 - C. satisfies the real need of the jobless
 - D. is lower than before the recession
39. It can be learned that with Obamacare, _____.
- A. it is no longer easy for part-timers to get insurance
 - B. employment is no longer a precondition to get insurance
 - C. it is still challenging to get insurance for family members
 - D. full-time employment is still essential for insurance.
40. The text mainly discusses_____.
- A. employment in the US
 - B. part-timer classification
 - C. insurance through Medicaid
 - D. Obamacare's trouble

13-1-1 快速时尚 Business Week 2012

In the 2006 film version of *The Devil Wears Prada*, Miranda Priestly, played by Meryl Streep, scolds her unattractive assistant for imagining that high fashion doesn't affect her. Priestly explains how the deep blue color of the assistant's sweater descended over the years from fashion shows to department stores and to the bargain bin in which the poor girl doubtless found her garment.

This top-down conception of the fashion business couldn't be more out of date or at odds with the feverish world described in *Overdressed*, Elizabeth Cline's three-year indictment of "fast fashion". In the last decade or so, advances in technology have allowed mass-market labels such as Zara, H&M, and Uniqlo to react to trends more quickly and anticipate demand more precisely. Quicker turnarounds mean less wasted inventory, more frequent release, and more profit. These labels encourage style-conscious consumers to see clothes as disposable—meant to last only a wash or two, although they don't advertise that—and to renew their wardrobe every few weeks. By offering on-trend items at dirt-cheap prices, Cline argues, these brands have hijacked fashion cycles, shaking an industry long accustomed to a seasonal pace.

The victims of this revolution, of course, are not limited to designers. For H&M to offer a \$5.95 knit miniskirt in all its 2,300-plus stores around the world, it must rely on low-wage overseas labor, order in volumes that strain natural resources, and use massive amounts of harmful chemicals.

Overdressed is the fashion world's answer to consumer-activist bestsellers like Michael Pollan's *The Omnivore's Dilemma*. "Mass-produced clothing, like fast food, fills a hunger and need, yet is non-durable and wasteful," Cline argues. Americans, she finds, buy roughly 20 billion garments a year – about 64 items per person – and no matter how much they give away, this excess leads to waste.

Towards the end of *Overdressed*, Cline introduced her ideal, a Brooklyn woman named Sarah Kate Beaumont, who since 2008 has made all of her own clothes – and beautifully. But as Cline is the first to note, it took Beaumont decades to perfect her craft; her example can't be knocked off.

Though several fast-fashion companies have made efforts to curb their impact on labor and the environment – including H&M, with its green Conscious Collection line – Cline believes lasting change can only be effected by the customer. She exhibits the idealism common to many advocates of sustainability, be it in food or in energy. Vanity is a constant; people will only start shopping more sustainably when they can't afford not to.

21. Priestly criticizes her assistant for her

- [A] lack of imagination.
- [B] poor bargaining skill.
- [C] obsession with high fashion.
- [D] insensitivity to fashion.

22. According to Cline, mass-market labels urge consumers to

- [A] combat unnecessary waste.
- [B] shop for their garments more frequently.
- [C] resist the influence of advertisements.
- [D] shut out the feverish fashion world.

23. The word "indictment" (Line 3, Para.2) is closest in meaning to

- [A] accusation.
- [B] enthusiasm.
- [C] indifference.
- [D] tolerance.

24. Which of the following can be inferred from the last paragraph?

- [A] Vanity has more often been found in idealists.
- [B] The fast-fashion industry ignores sustainability.
- [C] Pricing is vital to environment-friendly purchasing.
- [D] People are more interested in unaffordable garments.

25. What is the subject of the text?

- [A] Satire on an extravagant lifestyle.
- [B] Challenge to a high-fashion myth.
- [C] Criticism of the fast-fashion industry.
- [D] Exposure of a mass-market secret.

13-1-2 对不允许广告商精细跟踪的反应和讨论 The Economist 2012

An old saying has it that half of all advertising budgets are wasted-the trouble is, no one knows which half. In the internet age, at least in theory, this fraction can be much reduced. By watching what people search for, click on and say online, companies can aim “behavioural” ads at those most likely to buy.

In the past couple of weeks a quarrel has illustrated the value to advertisers of such fine-grained information: Should advertisers assume that people are happy to be tracked and sent behavioural ads? Or should they have explicit permission?

In December 2010 America's Federal Trade Commission (FTC) proposed adding a "do not track "(DNT) option to internet browsers ,so that users could tell advertisers that they did not want to be followed .Microsoft's Internet Explorer and Apple's Safari both offer DNT ;Google's Chrome is due to do so this year. In February the FTC and Digital Advertising Alliance (DAA) agreed that the industry would get cracking on responding to DNT requests.

On May 31st Microsoft Set off the row: It said that Internet Explorer 10,the version due to appear windows 8, would have DNT as a default.

It is not yet clear how advertisers will respond. Getting a DNT signal does not oblige anyone to stop tracking, although some companies have promised to do so. Unable to tell whether someone really objects to behavioural ads or whether they are sticking with Microsoft's default, some may ignore a DNT signal and press on anyway.

Also unclear is why Microsoft has gone it alone. After all, it has an ad business too, which it says will comply with DNT requests, though it is still working out how. If it is trying to upset Google, which relies almost wholly on default will become the norm. DNT does not seem an obviously huge selling point for windows 8-though the firm has compared some of its other products favourably with Google's on that count before. Brendon Lynch, Microsoft's chief privacy officer, blogged: "we believe consumers should have more control." Could it really be that simple?

26. It is suggested in paragraph 1 that “behavioural” ads help advertisers to:

- [A] lower their operational costs
- [B] ease competition among themselves
- [C] avoid complaints from consumers
- [D] provide better online services

27. “The industry” (Line 6,Para.3) refers to:

- [A] online advertisers
- [B] e-commerce conductors
- [C] digital information analysis
- [D] internet browser developers

28. Bob Liodice holds that setting DNT as a default

- [A] goes against human nature
- [B] fails to affect the ad industry
- [C] will not benefit consumers

[D] may cut the number of junk ads

29. which of the following is true according to Paragraph.6?

[A] Advertisers are willing to implement DNT

[B] DNT may not serve its intended purpose

[C] DNT is losing its popularity among consumers

[D] Advertisers are obliged to offer behavioural ads

30. The author's attitude towards what Brendon Lynch said in his blog is one of:

[A] appreciation

[B] understanding

[C] indulgence

[D] skepticism

09-1-3 教育与经济发展 Mckinsey Quarterly 2003

The relationship between formal education and economic growth in poor countries is widely misunderstood by economists and politicians alike. Progress in both areas is undoubtedly necessary for the social, political and intellectual development of these and all other societies; however, the conventional view that education should be one of the very highest priorities for promoting rapid economic development in poor countries is wrong. We are fortunate that is it, because new educational systems there and putting enough people through them to improve economic performance would require two or three generations. The findings of a research institution have consistently shown that workers in all countries can be trained on the job to achieve radical higher productivity and, as a result, radically higher standards of living.

Ironically, the first evidence for this idea appeared in the United States. Not long ago, with the country entering a recession and Japan at its pre-bubble peak. The U.S. workforce was derided as poorly educated and one of primary cause of the poor U.S. economic performance. Japan was, and remains, the global leader in automotive-assembly productivity. Yet the research revealed that the U.S. factories of Honda Nissan, and Toyota achieved about 95 percent of the productivity of their Japanese counterparts -- a result of the training that U.S. workers received on the job.

More recently, while examining housing construction, the researchers discovered that illiterate, non-English-speaking Mexican workers in Houston, Texas, consistently met best-practice labor productivity standards despite the complexity of the building industry's work.

What is the real relationship between education and economic development? We have to suspect that continuing economic growth promotes the development of education even when governments don't force it. After all, that's how education got started. When our ancestors were hunters and gatherers 10,000 years ago, they didn't have time to wonder much about anything besides finding food. Only when humanity began to get its food in a more productive way was there time for other things.

As education improved, humanity's productivity potential increased as well. When the competitive environment pushed our ancestors to achieve that potential, they could in turn afford more education. This increasingly high level of education is probably a necessary, but not a sufficient, condition for the complex political systems required by advanced economic performance. Thus poor countries might not be able to

escape their poverty traps without political changes that may be possible only with broader formal education. A lack of formal education, however, doesn't constrain the ability of the developing world's workforce to substantially improve productivity for the forested future. On the contrary, constraints on improving productivity explain why education isn't developing more quickly there than it is.

31. The author holds in paragraph 1 that the importance of education in poor countries _____.
[A] is subject groundless doubts
[B] has fallen victim of bias
[C] is conventional downgraded
[D] has been overestimated
32. It is stated in paragraph 1 that construction of a new education system _____.
[A] challenges economists and politicians
[B] takes efforts of generations
[C] demands priority from the government
[D] requires sufficient labor force
33. A major difference between the Japanese and U.S workforces is that _____.
[A] the Japanese workforce is better disciplined
[B] the Japanese workforce is more productive
[C] the U.S workforce has a better education
[D] the U.S workforce is more organize
34. The author quotes the example of our ancestors to show that education emerged _____.
[A] when people had enough time
[B] prior to better ways of finding food
[C] when people no longer went hungry
[D] as a result of pressure on government
35. According to the last paragraph, development of education _____.
[A] results directly from competitive environments
[B] does not depend on economic performance
[C] follows improved productivity
[D] cannot afford political changes

女董事越多企业欺诈越少

Having more women on company boards reduces fraud, according to a new study from China, which says “the optimal percentage of women on boards is 50 percent” — higher than the average anywhere in the world.

“I think this is really important now,” said Oliver Rui, a professor of finance and accounting at the China Europe International Business School who is based in the school’s Shanghai campus. He is one of three authors of the study, along with Douglas Cumming of York University Schulich School of Business and Tak Yan Leung from the Open University of Hong Kong.

“Fraud is very major, everywhere. Not just in the United States, but worldwide, and it’s hurting shareholders,” Mr. Rui said in an interview, adding that it was a significant problem in China, too. On average, an organization lost about 5 percent of revenue to fraud annually, the authors said, citing a 2010 report by the Association of Certified Fraud Examiners.

But it wasn’t that women were necessarily more honest. Rather, their presence created gender diversity, and that was the key, the study said:

“The examined data are more supportive of the gender diversity hypothesis relative to the women are more ethically sensitive hypothesis.”

The study looked at 1,422 instances of investigated fraud in Chinese companies over a 10-year period, from 2001 to 2010, and found “strong evidence” that the more male-dominated the board, the higher the likelihood of fraud. The data for the detected cases came from the China Securities Regulatory Commission.

Mr. Rui said women in business suffered less from overconfidence than men, and were more risk-averse, with the study pointing to conclusions that were globally valid.

How exactly did gender diversity help mitigate the problem?

The authors identified several key factors: More women in top positions broadened the talent pool and potentially paved the way for a more talented board; gender diversity allowed for a diversity of views, leading to greater discussion; and gender diversity could lead to potentially more conflict between board members, less trust, and hence increased scrutiny and less fraud, they said.

Women were “more likely to adopt a measured expansion rate” that protected shareholders’ investments, the study said.

Securities fraud is a white-collar crime in which a person or company misrepresents information that investors use to make decisions. The three major types of securities fraud identified by the study in China were the postponement of disclosures, major failures to disclose information, and false statements.

The study aligns with findings elsewhere in the world, and led the scholars to conclude that the presence of more women improves corporate governance, “implying that regulators and policymakers should consider the worldwide call for more gender-diverse boards.”

The relative scarcity of women on boards of directors is a global issue. According to a 2009 study, just one country, Slovenia, had an average of more than 20 percent women on boards, while the United States averaged 15 percent and China and Australia were more typical, averaging 10 percent. Many European countries, such as Portugal, France, Denmark, and Germany had roughly 5 percent female representation on boards. Ten countries had less than 5 percent female representation, with Japan the lowest at less than 1 percent, it said. The study pointed out that China too was a “male-dominated society.”

Recently, recognizing the issue, Norway and some other European countries have begun mandating quotas for women on boards, in an effort to raise the number.

Not only was a greater female presence a protection against fraud, but the response from the market to fraud when it did arise from a more gender diverse board was “significantly less pronounced,” the study found.

“Women are more effective in mitigating both the presence and severity of fraud in male-dominated industries, which again supports the notion of diversity,” it said.

3.科技类

15-1-2 个人私密数据保护 The Washington Post 2014

Just how much does the Constitution protect your digital data ? The Supreme Court will now consider whether police can search the contents of a mobile phone without a warrant if the phone is on or around a person during an arrest.

California has asked the justices to refrain from a sweeping ruling, particularly one that upsets the old assumption that authorities may search through the possessions of suspects at the time of their arrest. It is hard, the state argues, for judges to assess the implications of new and rapidly changing technologies.

The court would be recklessly modest if it followed California's advice. Enough of the implications are discernable, even obvious, so that the justice can and should provide updated guidelines to police, lawyers and defendants.

They should start by discarding California's lame argument that exploring the contents of a smart phone- a vast storehouse of digital information is similar to say, going through a suspect's purse .The court has ruled that police don't violate the Fourth Amendment when they go through the wallet or pocketbook, of an arrestee without a warrant. But exploring one's smart phone is more like entering his or her home. A smart phone may contain an arrestee's reading history, financial history, medical history and comprehensive records of recent correspondence. The development of "cloud computing." meanwhile, has made that exploration so much easier.

Americans should take steps to protect their digital privacy. But keeping sensitive information on these devices is increasingly a requirement of normal life. Citizens still have a right to expect private documents to remain private and protected by the Constitution's prohibition on unreasonable searches.

As so often is the case, stating that principle doesn't ease the challenge of line-drawing. In many cases, it would not be overly burdensome for authorities to obtain a warrant to search through phone contents. They could still invalidate Fourth Amendment protections when facing severe, urgent circumstances, and they could take reasonable measures to ensure that phone data are not erased or altered while waiting for a warrant. The court, though, may want to allow room for police to cite situations where they are entitled to more freedom.

But the justices should not swallow California's argument whole. New, disruptive technology sometimes demands novel applications of the Constitution's protections. Orin Kerr, a law professor, compares the explosion and accessibility of digital information in the 21st century with the establishment of automobile use as a virtual necessity of life in the 20th: The justices had to specify novel rules for the new personal domain of the passenger car then; they must sort out how the Fourth Amendment applies to digital information now.

26. The Supreme court, will work out whether, during an arrest, it is legitimate to_____.

- [A] search for suspects' mobile phones without a warrant.
- [B] check suspects' phone contents without being authorized.
- [C] prevent suspects from deleting their phone contents.
- [D] prohibit suspects from using their mobile phones.

27. The author's attitude toward California's argument is one of_____.
- [A] tolerance.
 - [B] indifference.
 - [C] disapproval.
 - [D] cautiousness.
28. The author believes that exploring one's phone content is comparable to_____.
- [A] getting into one's residence.
 - [B] handing one's historical records.
 - [C] scanning one's correspondences.
 - [D] going through one's wallet.
29. In Paragraph 5 and 6, the author shows his concern that_____.
- [A] principles are hard to be clearly expressed.
 - [B] the court is giving police less room for action.
 - [C] phones are used to store sensitive information.
 - [D] citizens' privacy is not effectively protected.
30. Orin Kerr's comparison is quoted to indicate that_____.
- [A] the Constitution should be implemented flexibly.
 - [B] new technology requires reinterpretation of the Constitution.
 - [C] California's argument violates principles of the Constitution.
 - [D] principles of the Constitution should never be altered

15-1-3 统计审查政策 Nature 2013

The journal Science is adding an extra round of statistical checks to its peer-review process, editor-in-chief Marcia McNutt announced today. The policy follows similar efforts from other journals, after widespread concern that basic mistakes in data analysis are contributing to the irreproducibility of many published research findings.

"Readers must have confidence in the conclusions published in our journal," writes McNutt in an editorial. Working with the American Statistical Association, the journal has appointed seven experts to a statistics board of reviewing editors (SBoRE). Manuscript will be flagged up for additional scrutiny by the journal's internal editors, or by its existing Board of Reviewing Editors or by outside peer reviewers. The SBoRE panel will then find external statisticians to review these manuscripts.

Asked whether any particular papers had impelled the change, McNutt said: "The creation of the 'statistics board' was motivated by concerns broadly with the application of statistics and data analysis in scientific research and is part of Science's overall drive to increase reproducibility in the research we publish."

Giovanni Parmigiani, a biostatistician at the Harvard School of Public Health, a member of the SBoRE group. He says he expects the board to "play primarily an advisory role." He agreed to join because he "found the foresight behind the establishment of the SBoRE to be novel, unique and likely to have a lasting impact. This impact will not only be through the publications in Science itself, but hopefully through a larger group of publishing places that may want to model their approach after Science."

John Ioannidis, a physician who studies research methodology, says that the policy is "a most welcome step forward" and "long overdue." "Most journals are weak in statistical review, and this damages the quality of what they publish. I think that, for the majority of scientific papers nowadays, statistical review is more essential than expert review," he says. But he noted that biomedical journals such as *Annals of Internal Medicine*, the *Journal of the American Medical Association* and *The Lancet* pay strong attention to statistical review.

Professional scientists are expected to know how to analyze data, but statistical errors are alarmingly common in published research, according to David Vaux, a cell biologist. Researchers should improve their standards, he wrote in 2012, but journals should also take a tougher line, "engaging reviewers who are statistically literate and editors who can verify the process". Vaux says that *Science*'s idea to pass some papers to statisticians "has some merit, but a weakness is that it relies on the board of reviewing editors to identify 'the papers that need scrutiny' in the first place".

31. It can be learned from Paragraph 1 that_____.

- [A] Science intends to simplify their peer-review process.
- [B] journals are strengthening their statistical checks.
- [C] few journals are blamed for mistakes in data analysis.
- [D] lack of data analysis is common in research projects.

32. The phrase "flagged up" (Para. 2) is the closest in meaning to_____.

- [A] found.
- [B] marked.
- [C] revised.
- [D] stored.

33. Giovanni Parmigiani believes that the establishment of the SBoRE may_____.

- [A] pose a threat to all its peers.
- [B] meet with strong opposition.
- [C] increase *Science*'s circulation.
- [D] set an example for other journals.

34. David Vaux holds that what *Science* is doing now_____.

- [A] adds to researchers' workload.
- [B] diminishes the role of reviewers.
- [C] has room for further improvement.
- [D] is to fail in the foreseeable future

35. Which of the following is the best title of the text?

- [A] Science Joins Push to Screen Statistics in Papers.
- [B] Professional Statisticians Deserve More Respect
- [C] Data Analysis Finds Its Way onto Editors' Desks
- [D] Statisticians Are Coming Back with Science

09-1-2 基因检测 Scientific American 2008

It is a wise father that knows his own child, but today a man can boost his paternal (fatherly) wisdom – or at least confirm that he's the kid's dad. All he needs to do is shell out \$30 for paternity testing kit (PTK) at his local drugstore – and another \$120 to get the results.

More than 60,000 people have purchased the PTKs since they first became available without prescriptions last year, according to Doug Fog, chief operating officer of Identigene, which makes the over-the-counter kits. More than two dozen companies sell DNA tests directly to the public, ranging in price from a few hundred dollars to more than \$2500.

Among the most popular: paternity and kinship testing, which adopted children can use to find their biological relatives and families can track down kids put up for adoption. DNA testing is also the latest rage among latest rage a many passionate genealogists-and supports businesses that offer to search for a family's geographic roots.

Most tests require collecting cells by webbing saliva in the mouth and sending it to the company for testing. All tests require a potential candidate with whom to compare DNA.

But some observers are skeptical, "There is a kind of false precision being hawked by people claiming they are doing ancestry testing," says Trey Duster, a New York University sociologist. He notes that each individual has many ancestors-numbering in the hundreds just a few centuries back. Yet most ancestry testing only considers a single lineage, either the Y chromosome inherited through men in a father's line or mitochondrial DNA, which is passed down only from mothers. This DNA can reveal genetic information about only one or two ancestors, even though, for example, just three generations back people also have six other great-grandparents or, four generations back, 14 other great-great-grandparents.

Critics also argue that commercial genetic testing is only as good as the reference collections to which a sample is compared. Databases used by some companies don't rely on data collected systematically but rather lump together information from different research projects. This means that a DNA database may differ depending on the company that processes the results. In addition, the computer programs a company uses to estimate relationships may be patented and not subject to peer review or outside evaluation.

26. In paragraphs 1 and 2, the text shows PTK's _____.
[A] easy availability
[B] flexibility in pricing
[C] successful promotion
[D] popularity with households
27. PTK is used to _____.
[A] locate one's birth place
[B] promote genetic research
[C] identify parent-child kinship
[D] choose children for adoption
28. Skeptical observers believe that ancestry testing fails to _____.
[A] trace distant ancestors

- [B] rebuild reliable bloodlines
 - [C] fully use genetic information
 - [D] achieve the claimed accuracy
29. In the last paragraph, a problem commercial genetic testing faces is _____.
- [A] disorganized data collection
 - [B] overlapping database building
 - [C] excessive sample comparison
 - [D] lack of patent evaluation
30. An appropriate title for the text is most likely to be _____.
- [A] For and Againsts of DNA testing
 - [B] DNA testing and Its problems
 - [C] DNA testing outside the lab
 - [D] lies behind DNA testing

13-1-3 人类未来 New Scientist 2012

Up until a few decades ago, our visions of the future were largely - though by no means uniformly - glowingly positive. Science and technology would cure all the ills of humanity, leading to lives of fulfillment and opportunity for all.

Now utopia has grown unfashionable, as we have gained a deeper appreciation of the range of threats facing us, from asteroid strike to epidemic flu and to climate change. You might even be tempted to assume that humanity has little future to look forward to.

But such gloominess is misplaced. The fossil record shows that many species have endured for millions of years - so why shouldn't we? Take a broader look at our species' place in the universe, and it becomes clear that we have an excellent chance of surviving for tens, if not hundreds, of thousands of years. Look up Homo sapiens in the "Red List" of threatened species of the International Union for the Conservation of Nature (IUCN), and you will read: "Listed as Least Concern as the species is very widely distributed, adaptable, currently increasing, and there are no major threats resulting in an overall population decline."

So what does our deep future hold? A growing number of researchers and organizations are now thinking seriously about that question. For example, the Long Now Foundation has its flagship project a medical clock that is designed to still be marking time thousands of years hence.

Perhaps willfully, it may be easier to think about such lengthy timescales than about the more immediate future. The potential evolution of today's technology, and its social consequences, is dazzlingly complicated, and it's perhaps best left to science fiction writers and futurologists to explore the many possibilities we can envisage. That's one reason why we have launched Arc, a new publication dedicated to the near future.

But take a longer view and there is a surprising amount that we can say with considerable assurance. As so often, the past holds the key to the future: we have now identified enough of the long-term patterns shaping the history of the planet, and our species, to make evidence-based forecasts about the situations in which our descendants will find themselves.

This long perspective makes the pessimistic view of our prospects seem more likely to be a passing fad. To be sure, the future is not all rosy. But we are now knowledgeable enough to reduce many of the risks that threatened the existence of earlier humans, and to improve the lot of those to come.

31. Our vision of the future used to be inspired by
- [A] our desire for lives of fulfillment
 - [B] our faith in science and technology
 - [C] our awareness of potential risks
 - [D] our belief in equal opportunity
32. The IUCN's "Red List" suggests that human beings are
- [A] a sustained species
 - [B] a threaten to the environment
 - [C] the world's dominant power
 - [D] a misplaced race
33. Which of the following is true according to Paragraph 5?
- [A] Arc helps limit the scope of futurological studies.
 - [B] Technology offers solutions to social problem.
 - [C] The interest in science fiction is on the rise.
 - [D] Our Immediate future is hard to conceive.
34. To ensure the future of mankind, it is crucial to
- [A] explore our planet's abundant resources
 - [B] adopt an optimistic view of the world
 - [C] draw on our experience from the past
 - [D] curb our ambition to reshape history
35. Which of the following would be the best title for the text?
- [A] Uncertainty about Our Future
 - [B] Evolution of the Human Species
 - [C] The Ever-bright Prospects of Mankind
 - [D] Science, Technology and Humanity

14-1-3 科技奖金 Nature 2013

The US\$3-million Fundamental Physics Prize is indeed an interesting experiment, as Alexander Polyakov said when he accepted this year's award in March. And it is far from the only one of its type. As a News Feature article in Nature discusses, a string of lucrative awards for researchers have joined the Nobel Prizes in recent years. Many, like the Fundamental Physics Prize, are funded from the telephone-number-sized bank accounts of Internet entrepreneurs. These benefactors have succeeded in their chosen fields, they say, and they want to use their wealth to draw attention to those who have succeeded in science.

What's not to like? Quite a lot, according to a handful of scientists quoted in the News Feature. You cannot buy class, as the old saying goes, and these upstart entrepreneurs cannot buy their prizes the prestige of

the Nobels, The new awards are an exercise in self-promotion for those behind them, say scientists. They could distort the achievement-based system of peer-review-led research. They could cement the status quo of peer-reviewed research. They do not fund peer-reviewed research. They perpetuate the myth of the lone genius.

The goals of the prize-givers seem as scattered as the criticism. Some want to shock, others to draw people into science, or to better reward those who have made their careers in research.

As Nature has pointed out before, there are some legitimate concerns about how science prizes—both new and old—are distributed. The Breakthrough Prize in Life Sciences, launched this year, takes an unrepresentative view of what the life sciences include. But the Nobel Foundation's limit of three recipients per prize, each of whom must still be living, has long been outgrown by the collaborative nature of modern research—as will be demonstrated by the inevitable row over who is ignored when it comes to acknowledging the discovery of the Higgs boson. The Nobels were, of course, themselves set up by a very rich individual who had decided what he wanted to do with his own money. Time, rather than intention, has given them legitimacy.

As much as some scientists may complain about the new awards, two things seem clear. First, most researchers would accept such a prize if they were offered one. Second, it is surely a good thing that the money and attention come to science rather than go elsewhere. It is fair to criticize and question the mechanism—that is the culture of research, after all—but it is the prize-givers' money to do with as they please. It is wise to take such gifts with gratitude and grace.

31. The Fundamental Physical Prize is seen as

- [A] a symbol of the entrepreneurs' wealth.
- [B] a possible replacement of the Nobel Prize.
- [C] an example of bankers' investment.
- [D] a handsome reward for researchers.

32. The critics think that the new awards will most benefit _____

- [A] the profit-oriented scientists.
- [B] the founders of the new award.
- [C] the achievement-based system.
- [D] peer-review-led research.

33. The discovery of the Higgs boson is a typical case which involves [A] controversies over the recipients' status.

- [B] the joint effort of modern researchers.
- [C] legitimate concerns over the new prize.
- [D] the demonstration of research findings.

34. According to Paragraph 4, which of the following is true of the Nobels?

- [A] Their endurance has done justice to them.
- [B] Their legitimacy has long been in dispute.
- [C] They are the most representative honor.
- [D] History has never cast doubt on them.

35. The author believed that the new awards are?

- [A] acceptable despite the criticism.

[B]harmful to the culture of research.

[C]subject to undesirable changes.

[D]unworthy of public attention.

06-1-3 过度捕捞

When prehistoric man arrived in new parts of the world, something strange happened to the large animals. They suddenly became extinct. Smaller species survived. The large, slow-growing animals were easy game, and were quickly hunted to extinction. Now something similar could be happening in the oceans.

That the seas are being overfished has been known for years. What researchers such as Ransom Myers and Boris Worm have shown is just how fast things are changing. They have looked at half a century of data from fisheries around the world. Their methods do not attempt to estimate the actual biomass (the amount of living biological matter) of fish species in particular parts of the ocean, but rather changes in that biomass over time. According to their latest paper published in *Nature*, the biomass of large predators (animals that kill and eat other animals) in a new fishery is reduced on average by 80% within 15 years of the start of exploitation. In some long-fished areas, it has halved again since then.

Dr. Worm acknowledges that these figures are conservative. One reason for this is that fishing technology has improved. Today's vessels can find their prey using satellites and sonar, which were not available 50 years ago. That means a higher proportion of what is in the sea is being caught, so the real difference between present and past is likely to be worse than the one recorded by changes in catch sizes. In the early days, too, longlines would have been more saturated with fish. Some individuals would therefore not have been caught, since no baited hooks would have been available to trap them, leading to an underestimate of fish stocks in the past. Furthermore, in the early days of longline fishing, a lot of fish were lost to sharks after they had been hooked. That is no longer a problem, because there are fewer sharks around now.

Dr. Myers and Dr. Worm argue that their work gives a correct baseline, which future management efforts must take into account. They believe the data support an idea current among marine biologists, that of the "shifting baseline." The notion is that people have failed to detect the massive changes which have happened in the ocean because they have been looking back only a relatively short time into the past. That matters because theory suggests that the maximum sustainable yield that can be cropped from a fishery comes when the biomass of a target species is about 50% of its original levels. Most fisheries are well below that, which is a bad way to do business.

31. The extinction of large prehistoric animals is noted to suggest that _____.

[A] large animal were vulnerable to the changing environment

[B] small species survived as large animals disappeared

[C] large sea animals may face the same threat today

[D] slow-growing fish outlive fast-growing ones

32. We can infer from Dr. Myers and Dr. Worm's paper that _____.

[A] the stock of large predators in some old fisheries has reduced by 90%

[B] there are only half as many fisheries as there were 15 years ago

- [C] the catch sizes in new fisheries are only 20% of the original amount
- [D] the number of larger predators dropped faster in new fisheries than in the old.
33. By saying "these figures are conservative" (Line 1, paragraph 3), Dr. Worm means that _____.
[A] fishing technology has improved rapidly
[B] the catch-sizes are actually smaller than recorded
[C] the marine biomass has suffered a greater loss
[D] the data collected so far are out of date
34. Dr. Myers and other researchers hold that _____.
[A] people should look for a baseline that can work for a longer time
[B] fisheries should keep their yields below 50% of the biomass
[C] the ocean biomass should be restored to its original level
[D] people should adjust the fishing baseline to the changing situation
35. The author seems to be mainly concerned with most fisheries' _____.
[A] management efficiency
[B] biomass level
[C] catch-size limits
[D] technological application